

ECHO
Environmental influences on Child Health Outcomes
A program supported by the NIH

Data Analysis Center

Release Notes for the 4th Release of ECHO Cohort Public Data

June 25, 2026

Prepared by the ECHO Data Analysis Center

Document History

Version	Date	Notes
1.0	December 15, 2023	Release notes for the second release of ECHO Cohort public data through the NICHD Data and Specimen Hub (DASH) repository (https://dash.nichd.nih.gov). Data correspond to an August 31, 2022 data lock by the ECHO Data Analysis Center.
2.0	August 31, 2024	Release notes for the third release of ECHO Cohort public data through the NICHD Data and Specimen Hub (DASH) repository (https://dash.nichd.nih.gov).
3.0	**August 1, 2026**	**Release notes for the fourth release of ECHO Cohort public data**

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1.0 General Information

The general information for the ECHO Cohort Study can be found at echochildren.org. This document provides general information about the fourth release of the ECHO Cohort Study public use data and highlights differences between the current release and the prior release.

2.0 Sample

The fourth release of ECHO Cohort Study public use data corresponds to data collected from participants enrolled in ECHO between October 1, 2018 and September 5, 2025. This release includes data on 46,403 pregnancies among 42,182 women, 42,224 children, and 902 partners of previously pregnant participants participating in ECHO Cohort Data Collection Protocol and extant data collected prior to October 1, 2018 that were consistent with measures on the Protocol.

Please review the *De-identification Documentation for the 4th Release of ECHO Cohort Public Data* for details of the exclusions from this release. Review the *Data Analyst Primer for the ECHO Cohort Public Data Release* for the organization of the data, basic study terminology, protocol definitions, and detailed summary of the data files.

3.0 Data Changes

The fourth release of ECHO Cohort public data includes accumulating data for participants included in the previous releases and data on participants enrolled to the ECHO Cohort Study between October 31, 2023 and September 5, 2025. The following account for additional data changes since the previous release.

- Resolution of data errors or inconsistencies may account for changes in the data submitted in the previous release.
- Introduction of the ECHO Data Warehouse as the primary analytical data structure.
- Integration of ECHO Cycle 1 and Cycle 2 data into a single database.
- Addition of Cycle 2 participants, visits, biospecimens, and assay results through September 2025.
- Standardized Cycle 2 visit groups and visit windows, with new harmonization mappings of Cycle 2 visits to Cycle 1 life stages to support cross-cycle analyses.
- Expanded data collection from previously pregnant participants and their partners during 36-month post-pregnancy period (referred to as the “pre-conception component of the protocol”).
- Expanded or updated set of derived variables encompassing Cycle 1 and 2 data to support cross-cycle analyses.

- Updated documentation for assay, biospecimen, administrative, Mobile Toolbox, and NIH Baby Toolbox data.
- Addition of analytical guidance regarding cohort clustering and dual-enrolled participants.

4.0 Additional Information

When using these data for manuscripts and presentations, investigators are legally required to acknowledge the funding sources from the National Institutes of Health (NIH) and other groups, along with the standard NIH disclaimer.

NIH Disclaimer:

"The content is solely the responsibility of the authors and does not necessarily represent the official views of the National Institutes of Health."

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5.0 Known Issues

The DAC makes the accumulating data available for ECHO Steering Committee-approved data analyses in a secure computing enclave. Study investigators work with the DAC and other data analysts to harmonize data needed to address research questions. Derived variables that have been constructed by the DAC from these harmonization efforts are included in this public release. However, harmonization efforts are ongoing and analysts using the data from this public release may need to create their own harmonized measures. Additionally, the data analyst should expect some inconsistencies and gaps in the data that will be resolved in subsequent releases.